Summary:

The research paper focused on the six most common skin lesions detected. These six consists of three types skin cancers (BCC , MEL and SCC) and three types of skin diseases (ACK , NEV , and SEK). We are provided a table, that shows the representation of each type of skin lesion in the dataset. Of all samples taken, are there approximately 53% samples of skin diseases and 47% samples of skin cancers.

There are in total 1373 patients, 1641 skin lesions and 2298 images in the dataset. In the dataset a patient may have one or more skin lesions and a skin lesion may have 1 or more pictures, which explains the different numbers. The images are taken with smartphones, so qualilty and ligtning may differ between the different images.

The metadata associated with the skin lesions has in total 26 attributes, 21 of which are patient clinical features. The values for the attributes ‘patient_id’ , ‘lesion_id’ , ‘img_id’ , ‘age’ , ‘region’ and ‘biopsed’ are always present.

All 100% of cancerous skin lesions have been biopsy-proven, but only 58% of all skin lesions, including the cancerous skin lesions, are biopsy-proven

This dataset has been made public in support to future research and development in making new tools to detect skin cancer, in particular to train CAD systems. Since there is a lack in public clinical images available to test these CAD systems, the hope is to make these systems better and more accurate to demographics that may not have specialists to detect the type of skin lesion.